VIRGIN ISLANDS NATIONAL PARK

VISITOR USE COUNTING AND REPORTING INSTRUCTIONS

Following are detailed instructions for collecting data and estimating visitor use statistics for **Virgin Islands National Park**. These instructions are effective the date of issuance and will continue in effect unless changed by agreement between the NPS Social Science Program and the Park Superintendent.

Recreation Visits

1. The Lind Point magnetometer traffic counter is located on North Shore Road opposite the Caneel Bay Overlook to monitor traffic in both directions. The monthly traffic count from 7 am to 6 pm (approximately dawn to dusk) is multiplied by 0.598 to account for duplicate daily reporting at this location, including entry & exit, multiple visits on the same day, and passthrough visitation. The adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 0.799 to estimate the number of recreation vehicles and eliminate non-recreation and non-reportable (NPS) vehicles. The final adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 2.869 persons per vehicle.

2. The count of people from item 1 above is multiplied by 0.296 to account for additional recreation visitors arriving via North Shore Road at Kings Hill or John Head Road at Catherineberg.

3. The count of people from item 1 above is multiplied by 0.092 to account for additional recreation visitors arriving into the Park via Route 10 (East End Road) at the NPS boundary along Borck Creek or the NPS boundary along Haulover Bays.

4. The count of people from item 1 above is multiplied by 0.029 to account for additional recreation visitors arriving into the Park via the end of Route 107 to Lameshur.

5. A magnetometer traffic counter is located on the unnamed road leading to the NPS Dock in Red Hook (St. Thomas). The monthly traffic count from 7 am to 4 pm (when the site is open) is divided by 2 to account for entry and exit. The adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 1.059 to account for vehicles that do not pass the traffic counter, and by 0.782 to estimate the number of recreation vehicles and eliminate non-recreation and non-reportable (NPS) vehicles. The final adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 1.839 persons per vehicle.

6. The unadjusted monthly traffic count from item 5 above is multiplied by 0.128 to estimate round trip pedestrian (i.e., walk-in) use in Red Hook. The pedestrian count is multiplied by 0.872 to estimate the number of recreation walk-in users and eliminate non-recreation and non-reportable (NPS) users.

7. A passive infrared trail counter is located on Lower Lind Point Trail (behind the Visitor Center). The monthly trail count is divided by 2 to account for entry and exit. The adjusted trail count is multiplied by 0.995 to estimate the number of recreation trail users and eliminate non-recreation and non-reportable (NPS) users.

8. A passive infrared trail counter is located on Reef Bay Trail. The monthly trail count is divided by 2 to account for entry and exit. The adjusted trail count is multiplied by 0.995 to estimate the number of recreation trail users and eliminate non-recreation and non-reportable (NPS) users.

9. A passive infrared trail counter is located on Salt Pond Bay Trail. The monthly trail count is divided by 2 to account for entry and exit. The adjusted count is multiplied by 0.95 to account for re-entries by some visitors. The final adjusted trail count is multiplied by 0.995 to estimate the

number of recreation trail users and eliminate non-recreation and non-reportable (NPS) users.

10. The count of recreation trail users from items 7, 8, and 9 above is multiplied by 0.224 to account for additional recreation trail visits in the park.

11. The number of boats visiting NPS Dock, bays along the north shore, and bays along the south shore is estimated by multiplying the unadjusted monthly traffic count (i.e., vehicles) from 7 am to 6 pm in item 1 above by 0.141. The boat count is multiplied by 0.95 to estimate the number of recreation boats and eliminate non-recreation and non-reportable (NPS) boats. The adjusted boat count is multiplied by 4.663 persons per boat. The final adjusted count is multiplied by 1.05 to account for additional recreation boating visitation in the park.

12. The number of visitors at the National Park Visitor Center is multiplied by 0.25 to account for duplicate reporting at other locations within the park.

Non-Recreation Visits

1. Non-recreation use at Lind Point is estimated using the monthly traffic count from 7 am to 6 pm (approximately dawn to dusk) and multiplying by 0.598 to account for duplicate daily reporting at this location, including entry & exit, multiple visits on the same day, and passthrough visitation. The adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 0.186 to estimate the number of non-recreation vehicles. The final adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 1.941 persons per vehicle.

2. The count of people from item 1 above is multiplied by 0.451 to account for additional non-recreation visitors arriving into the Park via North Shore Road at Kings Hill or John Head Road at Catherineberg.

3. The count of people from item 1 above is multiplied by 0.472 to account for additional non-recreation visitors arriving into the Park via Route 10 (East End Road) at the NPS boundary along Borck Creek or the NPS boundary along Haulover Bays.

4. The count of people from item 1 above is multiplied by 0.020 to account for additional non-recreation visitors arriving into the Park via the end of Route 107 to Lameshur.

5. The monthly traffic count at Lind Point from 6 pm to 7 am accounts for additional non-recreation passthrough visitation overnight. This overnight count is multiplied by 1.941 persons per vehicle.

6. Non-recreation use on the unnamed road leading to the NPS Dock in Red Hook (St. Thomas) is estimated using the monthly traffic count from 7 am to 4 pm (when the site is open) and dividing by 2 to account for entry and exit. The adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 1.059 to account for vehicles that do not pass the traffic counter, and by 0.088 to estimate the number of non-recreation vehicles. The final adjusted traffic count is multiplied by 1.839 persons per vehicle.

7. The unadjusted monthly traffic count from item 6 above is multiplied by 0.128 to estimate round trip walk-in use in Red Hook. The pedestrian count is multiplied by 0.128 to estimate the number of non-recreation walk-in users.

8. Non-recreation use on trails is estimated using the sum of items 7, 8, 9, and 10 from the Recreation Visits section, and multiplying by 0.004.

9. Non-recreation boating use is estimated by multiplying item 11 from the Recreation Visits section by 0.05.

Recreation Visitor Hours

Recreation visits are multiplied by 6.15 hours.

Non-Recreation Visitor Hours

1. Land-based non-recreation visits are multiplied by 0.25 hours (15 minutes).
2. North shore and south shore non-recreation boat use visits are multiplied by 6 hours.

Overnight Stays

Concessioner Lodging and Campgrounds

The number of visitors staying overnight as reported by the concessioner.

Boat campers

The number of overnight stays by boat campers at bays along the north shore and south shore is estimated by multiplying item 11 from the Recreation Visits section by 0.347.

Non-recreation Overnight Stays

The number of non-recreation overnight stays is estimated by multiplying item 9 from the Non-Recreation Visits section (i.e., the non-recreation boat use at north shore and south shore) by 0.10.